Publication Release Control SOP 4.2

Owner: Publication quality lead

Effective from: 2026-07-01T00:00:00+08:00

Evidence cutoff: 2026-08-26T17:00:00+08:00

Timezone: Asia/Singapore

Scope: accepted manuscripts, proof figures, supporting analysis exports, and coupled public deposits.

1. Effective time and component authority

First retain an event only when its parseable timestamp, normalized to Asia/Singapore, is at or before the evidence cutoff. Eligibility does not create authority.

An accepted component is superseded only when the exact replacement hash is proof-linked and the request, corresponding-author approval, and PQL approval all name that component.

Final approval of the version to be published is an ICMJE responsibility principle; the component-scope test in this SOP is the centre operational rule.

2. Display and clearance tolerance

Every panel must agree in identity, cohort label, colour, category order, median, both uncertainty endpoints, unit, annotation, and authorization.

For a two-decimal mark, absolute difference from round-half-up(source,2) must be less than or equal to 0.005. Geometry must be within one rendered pixel and less than or equal to 0.005 axis units.

Boundary examples: 0.005 passes; 0.006 fails. A matching median does not cure a failed endpoint, label, colour, order, annotation, unit, or authority link.

ICMJE calls for appropriate reporting of measurement error or uncertainty. The numeric tolerance above is an internally authored centre rule.

3. Hash lineage and historical states

Recompute full lowercase SHA-256 bytes for every asserted file-identity link. Hash equality proves identity but never expands approval scope.

Prior versions remain visible historical context when a later approved and hash-linked current object exists. A prior version returns to control only through an eligible explicit rollback or invalidation matching the same component scope.

Changed article versions should be dated and prior electronic versions should note newer versions, consistent with ICMJE version-archiving recommendations.

4. Coupled release and status precedence

Allowed coupled gate states: QA_REVIEW_OPEN, RELEASE, RELEASE_AFTER_CORRECTIONS, HOLD.

Evaluate blocking precedence in this order: HOLD over RELEASE_AFTER_CORRECTIONS over RELEASE.

Any unresolved mandatory panel correction, unapproved changed component, unsynchronized mapped deposit item, or missing final reapproval blocks both linked components. The proof and deposit may not receive contradictory terminal states.

5. Owners, service levels, and lock

PD-EDITOR owns proof rendering; EMC-STAT owns export confirmation; CA-STUDY owns manuscript wording approval; REPO-STEW owns deposit metadata and row verification; PQL owns coupled re-review.

All action due times use Asia/Singapore and must precede PQL re-review and the production lock at 2026-08-28T18:00:00+08:00.

The responsible-author contact principle and software package/version disclosure are grounded in ICMJE recommendations; case routing times remain centre controls.